

PLAYCIRCLE CLUB LEAGUE (PCL)

Season 1 Proof of Concept Complete Operating Framework

1. Overview

PlayCircle Club League (PCL) is a club-based pickleball league designed to create stronger retention, stronger community identity, recurring participation, and long-term engagement inside the PlayCircle ecosystem.

The league is built around club pride, competitive balance, seasonal rankings, matchday excitement, and supporter participation.

PCL Season 1 is designed as a Proof of Concept. The goal is not to overbuild the league from day one, but to validate whether clubs, players, and supporters are willing to participate in a structured seasonal competition.

2. Main Objective

The objective of PCL Season 1 is to prove that a club-based pickleball league can:

1. Increase player retention
2. Increase app engagement
3. Increase club loyalty
4. Create recurring weekly participation
5. Create rivalry and community excitement
6. Generate social media content
7. Prepare the foundation for sponsorship and future monetization

The main success signal is:

Clubs and players asking when Season 2 will begin.

3. Recommended Season 1 Format

For Season 1, the recommended format is:

Single Round Robin Regular Season + Top 4 Playoffs

This means each club plays every other club once during the regular season.

Reason:

1. Easier to manage
2. Faster to complete
3. Lower operational burden
4. Better for POC validation
5. Less scheduling risk
6. Easier for players to commit

Home-and-away format can be introduced in later seasons after the league has proven demand.

4. Recommended Number of Clubs

Ideal POC Size

The best size for PCL Season 1 is:

6 clubs

Reason:

1. Enough clubs to create variety
 2. Not too many matches to manage
 3. Easier to finish within 7–8 weeks
 4. Enough competition to create ranking tension
 5. Suitable for early-stage operations
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Club Participation Range

Category	Number of Clubs
Minimum viable league	4 clubs
Recommended POC league	6 clubs
Strong POC league	8 clubs
Maximum for Season 1	10 clubs

5. Club and Team Structure

Each club registers a fixed squad before the season begins.

Squad Size

Squad Type	Number of Players
Main Players	6 players
Reserve Players	2 players
Maximum Squad Size	8 players

Only registered players can represent the club during the season.

Player Eligibility

Each player must:

1. Register under one club only
2. Complete PlayCircle player profile
3. Complete skill self-assessment
4. Accept league rules and terms
5. Agree to match result recording
6. Agree to player rating and ranking updates
7. Follow the PCL code of conduct

A player cannot represent more than one club in the same season.

Squad Lock Rule

Once the season starts, each club's squad is locked.

No new players can be added during the season unless approved by PCL Admin due to:

1. Injury
2. Withdrawal
3. Relocation
4. Long-term unavailability
5. Emergency replacement

Replacement players must not unfairly strengthen the club.

Transfer Rule

For Season 1:

1. No transfers are allowed during the active season
2. Player movement is only allowed after the season ends
3. A player cannot play for two clubs in the same season

This keeps Season 1 simple, fair, and easier to manage.

6. Fair Match Mechanism

Fairness is critical. If the league feels unfair, weaker clubs will stop participating and stronger clubs will dominate too easily.

The purpose of the fair match mechanism is to prevent super teams and create competitive matches.

Player Rating Categories

Each player is assigned a rating category before the season starts.

Category	Description	Rating Points
Bronze	Beginner to lower intermediate	50
Silver	Intermediate social player	70
Gold	Strong intermediate to advanced	90
Platinum	Advanced competitive player	110

How Player Rating Is Assigned

Player rating can be assigned based on:

1. Self-assessment form
2. Previous match history
3. Club captain recommendation
4. Short evaluation session
5. Admin review
6. Known tournament experience

If there is uncertainty, the player should be placed in the higher category to avoid sandbagging.

Squad Rating Cap

Each club must stay within the squad rating cap.

Recommended Season 1 Squad Rating Cap:

680 points maximum for 8 registered players

Example:

Player	Category	Points
Player 1	Platinum	110
Player 2	Gold	90
Player 3	Gold	90
Player 4	Silver	70
Player 5	Silver	70
Player 6	Silver	70
Player 7	Bronze	50
Player 8	Bronze	50
Total		600

This squad is accepted because it is below 680 points.

Composition Cap

To prevent unfair stacking, each squad should follow this maximum composition:

Category	Maximum Per Squad
Platinum	Maximum 2 players
Gold	Maximum 3 players
Silver	No limit
Bronze	No limit

Recommended rule:

A club cannot register more than 2 Platinum players in one squad.

Matchday Rating Cap

Each club fields 6 active players on matchday.

Recommended Matchday Rating Cap:

560 rating points maximum for 6 active players

This prevents a club from always fielding an overly strong lineup if the squad is stacked.

Pairing Balance Rule

Each club forms 3 core doubles pairs:

Pair Type	Suggested Composition
Pair A	Strongest pair
Pair B	Mid-level pair
Pair C	Development or lower-rated pair

The match structure should follow:

1. Pair A vs Pair A
2. Pair B vs Pair B
3. Pair C vs Pair C
4. Mixed Rotation Match
5. Captain's Match

This reduces extreme mismatch and keeps games competitive.

Anti-Sandbagging Rule

Sandbagging means a strong player intentionally registers or performs as a lower-level player to gain unfair advantage.

PCL Admin may review and upgrade a player's rating if:

1. Player consistently dominates opponents
2. Player has strong past tournament records

3. Multiple clubs submit complaints
4. Result patterns show clear imbalance
5. Player was clearly underrated during registration

PCL Admin's decision is final.

7. Matchday Format

Each club vs club meeting is called one Tie.

One Tie consists of 5 doubles matches.

Each club fields 6 active players.

Matchday Structure

Match	Format
Match 1	Pair A vs Pair A
Match 2	Pair B vs Pair B
Match 3	Pair C vs Pair C
Match 4	Mixed Rotation Match
Match 5	Captain's Match

The club that wins at least 3 out of 5 matches wins the Tie.

Player Participation Rule

Each active player should play at least 1 match.

Recommended limit:

Rule	Limit
Minimum match per active player	1 match
Maximum match per active player per Tie	2 matches

This prevents a club from relying only on its strongest players.

8. Match Scoring System

PCL Season 1 will use a badminton-style scoring system adapted for pickleball.

Each doubles match is played to 15 points.

The first pair to reach 15 points wins the match.

Standard Match Win

A match is won when one pair reaches 15 points before the opponent.

Example:

Score Winner

15–8 Pair A

15–11 Pair A

15–13 Pair A

14–14 Serve-to-Win Rule

If the score reaches 14–14, the match enters Serve-to-Win mode.

Under Serve-to-Win:

1. The team currently serving has the opportunity to win the match
2. If the serving team wins the rally, they win the match 15–14

3. If the receiving team wins the rally, they do not win the match immediately
4. The serve changes to the receiving team
5. The new serving team then has the opportunity to win the next rally
6. This continues until a serving team wins the rally and closes the match

Important clarification:

At 14–14, a team can only win the match by winning the rally while serving.

Serve-to-Win Examples

Situation	Result
Pair A leads 14–13 and wins next rally	Pair A wins 15–13
Score is 14–14, Pair A is serving and wins rally	Pair A wins 15–14
Score is 14–14, Pair A is serving and loses rally	Serve changes to Pair B, score remains 14–14
Score is 14–14, Pair B serves and wins rally	Pair B wins 15–14
Score is 14–14, Pair B serves and loses rally	Serve changes back to Pair A, score remains 14–14

9. No Draw Rule

PCL Season 1 will not allow draw results.

Every Tie must produce a winner.

Since each Tie consists of 5 doubles matches, the club that wins at least 3 out of 5 matches wins the Tie.

Possible Tie results:

Tie Result	Meaning
5–0	Clean sweep

4–1	Strong win
3–2	Close win
2–3	Close loss
1–4	Heavy loss
0–5	Clean defeat

10. League Points System

Main League Points

Tie Result	League Points
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Win Tie	3 points
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Lose Tie	0 points
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There is no draw point because PCL Season 1 does not allow draw results.

Bonus Points

Bonus points are used to make the league more competitive and keep clubs motivated until the end.

Bonus Type	Condition	Points
Clean Sweep Bonus	Winning club wins 5–0	+1 League Point
Close Fight Bonus	Losing club loses narrowly 2–3	+1 League Point
Giant Killer Bonus	Lower-ranked club beats a top 2 club	+1 League Point
Attendance Bonus	Club reaches minimum supporter target	+1 Support Point only

Important note:

Attendance Bonus does not affect competitive League Points.
It only affects the Club Support Ranking.

This protects sporting fairness.

League Points Examples

Example 1: Clean Sweep

Club A beats Club B 5–0.

Club	Tie Result	Bonus	Total Points
Club A	Win = 3	Clean Sweep = 1	4
Club B	Loss = 0	None	0

Example 2: Close Match

Club C beats Club D 3–2.

Club	Tie Result	Bonus	Total Points
Club C	Win = 3	None	3
Club D	Loss = 0	Close Fight = 1	1

Example 3: Giant Killer Result

Club E is ranked 5th and beats Club A, who is ranked in the top 2.

Final Tie Result:

Club E wins 3–2.

Club	Tie Result	Bonus	Total Points
Club E	Win = 3	Giant Killer = 1	4
Club A	Loss = 0	Close Fight = 1, if losing 2–3	1

11. League Standings and Tie Breakers

League ranking is based on:

1. Total League Points
 2. Match Difference
 3. Head-to-Head Result
 4. Total Matches Won
 5. Total Point Difference
 6. Playoff Decider or Admin Decision
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Match Difference

Match Difference = Matches Won - Matches Lost

Example:

Club A wins a Tie 4–1.

Match Difference:

$$4 - 1 = +3$$

Total Point Difference

Total Point Difference = Total points scored across all matches - Total points conceded across all matches

Example:

Club A scored 70 total points and conceded 55 total points.

Point Difference:

$70 - 55 = +15$

12. League Table Format

Example League Table:

Rank	Club	Played	Win	Loss	Matches Won	Matches Lost	Match Diff	Bonus	Points
1	Club A	5	4	1	18	7	+11	2	14
2	Club B	5	4	1	16	9	+7	1	13
3	Club C	5	3	2	14	11	+3	2	11
4	Club D	5	2	3	11	14	-3	1	7
5	Club E	5	1	4	9	16	-7	2	5
6	Club F	5	1	4	7	18	-11	0	3

13. Club Support Ranking

Club Support Ranking is separate from League Standings.

This allows supporters and non-playing members to contribute without affecting competitive fairness.

Support Points System

Activity	Support Points
Match attendance check-in	+1 per supporter
MVP voting participation	+1 per voter

Match prediction participation	+1 per participant
Social media post tagging PCL	+2 per valid post
Club brings 10+ supporters	+10 bonus
Best Club Spirit selected by admin	+10 bonus

Support Ranking Table

Rank	Club	Attendance Points	Voting Points	Prediction Points	Social Points	Bonus	Total Support Points
1	Club A	80	40	35	20	10	185
2	Club B	60	35	30	16	10	151
3	Club C	45	25	20	10	0	100

14. Team Registration Table

[illegible]

Club E	Name	Name	Name	Name	Name	Name	Name	Name	Name	650
Club F	Name	Name	Name	Name	Name	Name	Name	Name	Name	630

15. Matchday Lineup Table

Club	Match 1 Pair A	Match 2 Pair B	Match 3 Pair C	Match 4 Mixed Rotation	Match 5 Captain's Match
Club A	Player 1 + Player 2	Player 3 + Player 4	Player 5 + Player 6	Player 1 + Player 4	Captain Pick
Club B	Player 1 + Player 2	Player 3 + Player 4	Player 5 + Player 6	Player 2 + Player 5	Captain Pick

16. Match Result Table

Tie	Match	Club A Pair	Club B Pair	Score	Winner
Club A vs Club B	Match 1	A1 + A2	B1 + B2	15–10	Club A
Club A vs Club B	Match 2	A3 + A4	B3 + B4	13–15	Club B
Club A vs Club B	Match 3	A5 + A6	B5 + B6	15–7	Club A
Club A vs Club B	Match 4	A1 + A4	B2 + B5	15–14	Club A
Club A vs Club B	Match 5	Captain Pick	Captain Pick	12–15	Club B

Final Tie Result:

Club A wins 3–2.

League Points:

Club	Points
Club A	3
Club B	1 Close Fight Bonus

17. Schedule Calculation Formula

Regular Season Formula

For single round robin:

Total Regular Season Ties = Number of Clubs x (Number of Clubs - 1) / 2

Example for 6 clubs:

$6 \times 5 / 2 = 15$ regular season ties

Playoff Formula

For 6 clubs and above:

Top 4 qualify for playoffs.

Playoff ties:

Stage	Number of Ties
Semi Final 1	1
Semi Final 2	1
Grand Final	1
Third Place Match	1
Total Playoff Ties	4

Total Season Ties Formula

Total Season Ties = Regular Season Ties + Playoff Ties

For 6 clubs:

15 regular season ties + 4 playoff ties = 19 total ties

18. Season Session Calculation

A session means one organized league event block at a venue.

One session can include multiple club ties depending on:

1. Number of available courts
 2. Venue booking duration
 3. Operational capacity
 4. Match speed
 5. Buffer time
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Recommended Operating Assumption

For PCL Season 1, assume:

1 Tie = 5 doubles matches

Each match = to 15 points

Average match time = 15–20 minutes

Transition and buffer per wave = 5 minutes

Venue Capacity Assumption

If using 3 courts

A Tie can be completed in 2 waves:

Wave	Matches Played
Wave 1	Match 1, Match 2, Match 3
Wave 2	Match 4, Match 5

Estimated Tie Duration:

Item	Duration
Wave 1	20 minutes
Transition	5 minutes
Wave 2	20 minutes
Result confirmation and buffer	10–15 minutes
Total per Tie	55–60 minutes

Recommended planning:

1 Tie = 60 minutes

Recommended Session Length

If using 3 courts:

Number of Ties in One Session	Estimated Duration
1 Tie	1 hour
2 Ties	2 hours
3 Ties	3 hours
3 Ties + opening/content/admin buffer	3.5–4 hours

Recommended PCL operating model:

- 3 ties per weekly session
- 3 courts minimum
- 3.5 to 4 hours per session

This allows all clubs to play in one weekly league event if there are 6 clubs.

19. Total Season Duration by Number of Clubs

The table below assumes:

- 1. Single round robin regular season
- 2. Top 4 playoffs for 6 clubs and above
- 3. 3 ties per weekly session
- 4. 3-court venue minimum
- 5. One league session per week

Season Duration Table

Number of Clubs	Regular Season Ties	Playoff Ties	Total Ties	Ties Per Weekly Session	Regular Season Sessions	Playoff Sessions	Total Sessions	Estimated Duration
4 Clubs	6	2	8	2–3	2–3	1	3–4 sessions	4–5 weeks
6 Clubs	15	4	19	3	5	2	7 sessions	7–8 weeks
8 Clubs	28	4	32	4	7	2	9 sessions	9–10 weeks
10 Clubs	45	4	49	5	9	2	11 sessions	11–12 weeks

Recommended Season 1 Choice

For PCL Season 1, the best format is:

6 clubs
15 regular season ties
4 playoff ties
19 total ties
7 league sessions
7–8 weeks total duration

This is the most balanced option for a POC.

20. Recommended PCL Season 1 Timeline

For 6 Clubs

Phase	Duration	Activity
Pre-Season	2 weeks	Club recruitment, squad registration, player rating, schedule confirmation
Regular Season	5 weeks	15 regular season ties, 3 ties per week
Semi Final Week	1 week	Rank 1 vs Rank 4, Rank 2 vs Rank 3
Grand Final Week	1 week	Grand Final, third-place match, award ceremony
Post-Season	1 week	Feedback, content recap, Season 2 recruitment

Total calendar duration:

9–10 weeks including pre-season and post-season.

Active competition duration:

7 weeks.

21. 6-Club Regular Season Schedule

Club Code Example

Code	Club Name
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A	Club A
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B	Club B
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C	Club C
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D	Club D
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E	Club E
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F	Club F
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Regular Season Schedule

Week	Tie 1	Tie 2	Tie 3
Week 1	Club A vs Club F	Club B vs Club E	Club C vs Club D
Week 2	Club A vs Club E	Club F vs Club D	Club B vs Club C
Week 3	Club A vs Club D	Club E vs Club C	Club F vs Club B
Week 4	Club A vs Club C	Club D vs Club B	Club E vs Club F
Week 5	Club A vs Club B	Club C vs Club F	Club D vs Club E

Playoff Schedule

Week	Stage	Tie
Week 6	Semi Final 1	Rank 1 vs Rank 4
Week 6	Semi Final 2	Rank 2 vs Rank 3
Week 7	Grand Final	Winner SF1 vs Winner SF2
Week 7	Third Place Match	Loser SF1 vs Loser SF2

22. Matching Tree

Regular Season Flow

6 Registered Clubs

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Single League Table

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Each Club Plays 5 Regular Season Ties

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League Points Accumulated

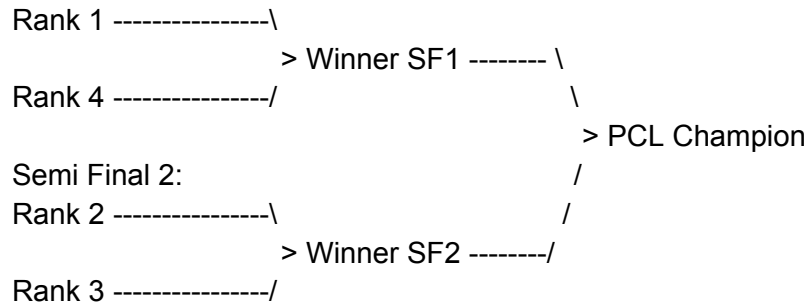
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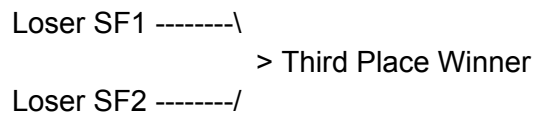
Top 4 Clubs Qualify for Playoffs

Playoff Matching Tree

Semi Final 1:



Third Place Match



23. Operational Plan Per Weekly Session

Recommended Weekly Session Flow

Time Block	Activity
0:00–0:15	Team arrival, check-in, warm-up
0:15–0:25	Captain briefing and lineup confirmation
0:25–1:25	Tie 1
1:25–2:25	Tie 2
2:25–3:25	Tie 3
3:25–3:45	Result confirmation, photos, content capture
3:45–4:00	Closing, ranking update, next week announcement

Recommended weekly venue booking:

4 hours

Required Courts

Recommended:

3 courts minimum

Reason:

1. Allows one Tie to finish within around 60 minutes
 2. Keeps weekly session within 4 hours
 3. Reduces player waiting time
 4. Makes matchday more energetic
 5. Allows better content capture
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Required Operating Team

Minimum operating team:

Role	Responsibility
League Manager	Oversees matchday operations
Match Coordinator	Handles lineup, match flow, results
Scorekeeper	Records scores and confirms results
Content Person	Captures photos, videos, highlights
App/Admin Support	Updates standings and player records

For POC, some roles can be combined.

24. Basic Rules

General Rules

1. All players must be registered before the season begins
 2. Each player can only represent one club per season
 3. Each club must submit matchday lineup before the Tie starts
 4. Late lineup changes require admin approval
 5. All results must be recorded in PlayCircle or official PCL result sheet
 6. Players must follow venue rules and sportsmanship standards
 7. PCL Admin has final decision authority in disputes
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Attendance Rules

1. Clubs must arrive at least 15 minutes before scheduled match time
 2. If a club is more than 15 minutes late, a warning may be issued
 3. If a club is more than 30 minutes late without valid reason, walkover may apply
 4. Repeated lateness may lead to penalties or disqualification
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Walkover Rules

A club may lose by walkover if:

1. It fails to field minimum required players
2. It does not attend the scheduled match
3. It violates major league rules
4. It refuses to continue without valid reason

Recommended walkover result:

Opponent wins 5–0.

Opponent receives:

3 points + 1 clean sweep bonus = 4 points

Walkover club receives:

0 points

Minimum Player Rule

Each club should field 6 active players for a full Tie.

If a club only has 5 players:

1. Admin may allow the Tie to proceed
2. The club may automatically forfeit one match

If fewer than 5 players attend:

Walkover may apply.

Sportsmanship Rules

Players must not:

1. Use abusive language
2. Intentionally intimidate opponents
3. Cheat or manipulate scores
4. Disrespect referees, admins, venue staff, or other players
5. Intentionally misrepresent skill level
6. Refuse to follow official league instructions

Violations may result in:

1. Warning
 2. Match penalty
 3. Point deduction
 4. Suspension
 5. Disqualification
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25. Terms and Conditions

Participation

By joining PCL, clubs and players agree to follow all official rules, schedules, scoring systems, and admin decisions.

Player Registration

All player information must be accurate. PCL Admin reserves the right to reject, adjust, or reclassify any player rating if needed.

Schedule Commitment

Clubs must commit to the official schedule. Rescheduling is only allowed with approval from PCL Admin.

Match Results

All match results must be submitted immediately after the Tie.

Once confirmed by both captains and PCL Admin, the result is final.

Disputes

Disputes must be submitted within 24 hours after the match.

PCL Admin may review:

1. Score records
2. Captain statements
3. Player statements
4. Video evidence if available

PCL Admin's final decision is binding.

Injury and Replacement

If a player is injured during the season, the club may request a replacement.

Replacement must be approved by PCL Admin and must not unfairly increase the club's strength.

Media Rights

By joining PCL, players and clubs agree that photos, videos, names, club names, match results, rankings, and highlights may be used by PlayCircle for promotional, social media, and league-related content.

Code of Conduct

All participants must behave respectfully and maintain the positive reputation of PCL and PlayCircle.

Final Authority

PCL Admin reserves the right to make final decisions in cases not clearly covered by the rules, with the intention of protecting fairness, safety, and league integrity.

26. Awards

Club Awards

Award	Description
PCL Champion	Winner of Grand Final
PCL Runner-Up	Losing finalist
Third Place	Winner of third-place match
Best Club Spirit	Best attitude, attendance, energy
Best Supporter Club	Highest support ranking
Fastest Growing Club	Highest member growth
Club of the Season	Best overall club performance and community engagement

Player Awards

Award	Description
Golden Paddle	Player with most match wins
League MVP	Best overall performance rating
Iron Paddle	Most matches played
Fan Favourite	Most supporter votes
Rising Star	Best new or improving player
Clutch Player	Best performance in close matches

27. PCL Season 1 Success Metrics

Metric	Target
Participating Clubs	6 clubs
Registered Players	48 players
Regular Season Ties	15 ties
Total Ties Including Playoffs	19 ties
Active Competition Sessions	7 sessions
Active Competition Duration	7 weeks
Full Project Duration Including Pre/Post Season	9–10 weeks
Match Attendance	80%+
Player Retention for Season 2	70%+
Supporter Participation	50%+ of club members
Clubs Recruiting for Season 2	Minimum 3 clubs
Organic Social Media Posts	Minimum 50 posts
Weekly App Engagement	Active usage from players and supporters

28. Final Strategic Conclusion

PCL Season 1 should be simple, fair, decisive, and emotionally engaging.

The recommended format is:

- 6 clubs
- 8 players per club
- 5 regular season weeks
- 2 playoff weeks
- 7 active competition sessions
- 9–10 weeks total including pre-season and post-season

The key is not to build a complicated league from day one.

The key is to prove that players care about:

1. Representing a club
2. Competing in a season
3. Improving standings
4. Building rivalries
5. Winning recognition
6. Supporting their own club

If Season 1 creates excitement and clubs ask to join Season 2, then PCL can evolve into a bigger ecosystem with:

1. Multiple divisions
2. Sponsor-backed awards
3. Fantasy league
4. Club XP system
5. Transfer windows
6. Regional championships
7. International club tournaments

The long-term vision is for PCL to become the most recognized club-based pickleball league in the region and the strongest retention engine inside the PlayCircle ecosystem.

PLAYCIRCLE CLUB LEAGUE (PCL)

Monetization Strategy Summary

1. Core Monetization Principle

PCL should not be monetized too aggressively in Season 1.

Season 1 should be treated as:

- Proof of concept
- Community builder
- Content engine
- Sponsor case study
- Retention experiment

The goal of Season 1 is not to maximize profit immediately. The goal is to prove that players, clubs, and supporters care enough to return for Season 2.

The recommended principle:

Build proof first. Monetize lightly. Scale revenue after demand is proven.

2. Main Revenue Streams

PCL can generate revenue through multiple layers:

1. Club registration fee
2. Player registration fee
3. Venue partnership or court revenue share
4. League sponsorship
5. Award sponsorship
6. Merchandise sales
7. Content and media sponsorship
8. App subscription upsell
9. Supporter pass
10. Fantasy league entry
11. Coaching and clinic upsell

For Season 1, the most suitable revenue streams are:

- Club registration fee
 - Small sponsorship packages
 - Merchandise pre-order
 - Venue partnership
 - Content sponsorship
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3. Club Registration Fee

Each participating club pays a fee to enter PCL.

This fee helps cover:

- League administration
 - Scheduling
 - Standings management
 - Matchday coordination
 - Content coverage
 - Referee or coordinator cost
 - Trophy and awards
 - Basic prize pool
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Suggested Season 1 Club Fee

Package	Fee Per Club	Suitable For
POC Friendly	RM 300–500	Low resistance, easy entry
Standard	RM 800–1,200	Better operations and content
Premium	RM 1,500–2,500	Includes jerseys, media, awards

Recommended Season 1 pricing:

RM 800–1,200 per club

Example:

Item	Calculation	Revenue
Club Registration	6 clubs x RM 1,000	RM 6,000

This is not designed to create large profit yet, but it creates commitment from participating clubs.

4. Player Registration Fee

PCL can also charge player participation fees.

Example:

Fee Per Player	Calculation	Revenue
RM 80	48 players x RM 80	RM 3,840
RM 100	48 players x RM 100	RM 4,800
RM 150	48 players x RM 150	RM 7,200

Player registration fee can include:

- League participation
- Player profile badge
- Ranking record
- Digital certificate
- Player statistics
- Eligibility for player awards

Recommended approach:

For Season 1, avoid charging both clubs and players too aggressively.

Better model:

- Club pays team registration fee
 - Player pays optional media/stat/profile upgrade fee later
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5. Venue Partnership / Court Revenue Share

PCL needs courts, so venue partnership is a critical monetization and cost-control strategy.

Option 1: Discounted Court Rental

Venue provides discounted court rental in exchange for:

- Exposure
 - Social media tagging
 - League traffic
 - Future booking volume
 - Venue partner recognition
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Option 2: Revenue Share

PCL brings players, clubs, and supporters to the venue.

Venue gives PlayCircle a commission or rebate from court usage.

Example:

Item	Value
Total court rental for season	RM 5,000
Venue rebate / commission at 20%	RM 1,000

Option 3: Venue Sponsorship

Venue becomes:

Official Venue Partner of PCL Season 1

This can be structured as:

- Free court hours
- Discounted booking
- Cash sponsorship
- Value exchange

Venue partnership is important because court cost can become one of the biggest operational expenses.

6. League Sponsorship

Sponsorship is the biggest long-term monetization opportunity for PCL.

Potential sponsor categories:

- Paddle brands
 - Shoe brands
 - Sportswear brands
 - Hydration brands
 - Wellness brands
 - Physiotherapy clinics
 - Pickleball courts
 - Cafes near courts
 - Lifestyle brands
 - Fitness brands
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Season 1 Sponsor Packages

Package	Price	Benefits
Supporting Sponsor	RM 1,000–2,000	Logo on posts, website mention
Award Sponsor	RM 2,000–4,000	Sponsor one award
Matchday Sponsor	RM 3,000–5,000	Branded matchday content
Title Sponsor	RM 8,000–15,000	“PCL Season 1 presented by Brand”

Recommended Season 1 target:

- 1 title sponsor, or
- 2–3 small sponsors

Even RM 5,000–10,000 total sponsorship is already useful for Season 1 because it creates proof for Season 2.

7. Award Sponsorship

Award sponsorship is easier to sell than full league sponsorship because it is specific and visible.

Examples:

- Golden Paddle Award sponsored by JOOLA
 - MVP Award sponsored by Franklin
 - Best Club Spirit sponsored by a local cafe
 - Fan Favourite Award sponsored by an apparel brand
 - Rising Star Award sponsored by a coaching clinic
-

Suggested Award Sponsorship Pricing

Award	Sponsor Fee
Golden Paddle	RM 2,000
MVP Award	RM 2,000
Fan Favourite	RM 1,000
Best Club Spirit	RM 1,000
Rising Star	RM 1,000

Potential total:

RM 7,000 from award sponsors

This is one of the most practical early monetization options.

8. Merchandise Sales

PCL can create strong merchandise demand because league identity creates pride and belonging.

Possible products:

- PCL official jersey
 - Club jersey
 - Limited edition shirts
 - Caps
 - Towels
 - Water bottles
 - Stickers
 - Paddle grip tape
 - Supporter kit
-

Recommended Season 1 Merchandise Model

Use pre-order only.

Do not hold large inventory in Season 1.

Example:

Item	Amount
PCL Shirt Selling Price	RM 79
Cost	RM 35
Gross Profit Per Shirt	RM 44

If 100 shirts are sold:

Calculation	Gross Profit
100 shirts x RM 44	RM 4,400

Merchandise should be positioned as identity, not just apparel.

Example:

“Official PCL Season 1 Shirt”

9. Content and Media Sponsorship

PCL can create weekly content that sponsors may want to attach their brand to.

Content assets:

- Match highlights
 - Player interviews
 - Club rivalry stories
 - Weekly ranking updates
 - Top 5 rallies
 - MVP clips
 - Club fan content
 - Grand final recap
-

Sponsorship Examples

- “PCL Weekly Recap powered by Brand X”
 - “Top 5 Rallies presented by Brand X”
 - “Player of the Week sponsored by Brand X”
 - “Matchday Highlights brought to you by Brand X”
-

Revenue Example

Item	Calculation	Revenue
Weekly Recap Sponsor	7 episodes x RM 800	RM 5,600

This is highly strategic because content creates proof, exposure, and future sponsor value.

10. App Subscription Upsell

PCL should not force subscription in Season 1.

However, PCL can increase the perceived value of PlayCircle premium features.

Possible premium features:

- Advanced player stats
- Detailed match history
- Club ranking analytics
- Early access to league registration
- Exclusive training content
- Priority social play slots
- Premium profile badge

Example:

Item	Calculation	Monthly Revenue
PlayCircle Premium	100 users x RM 19/month	RM 1,900/month

Recommended timing:

Introduce subscription after Season 1, once users already understand the value of stats, rankings, and club identity.

11. Supporter Pass / Fan Pass

Supporter Pass can be introduced once club identity becomes stronger.

Possible supporter pass benefits:

- Digital club supporter badge
- MVP voting power
- Fantasy league access
- Supporter leaderboard
- Exclusive content
- Merchandise discount
- Grand final priority access

Example pricing:

Pricing Model	Revenue Example
RM 9.90/month	Recurring supporter revenue
RM 29/season	300 supporters x RM 29 = RM 8,700

Recommended timing:

Season 2 or later.

Do not introduce this too early unless supporter demand is clearly visible.

12. Fantasy League Entry

Fantasy league should be a Season 2 or Season 3 feature.

Users create fantasy teams using real PCL players.

Fantasy points can come from:

- Player wins
- MVP awards
- Match participation
- Clutch performances
- Clean sweep contribution

Example:

Item	Calculation	Revenue
Fantasy Entry	500 users x RM 10	RM 5,000

Important:

Avoid gambling framing.

Fantasy league should be positioned as:

- Entertainment

- Community competition
- Engagement mechanic
- Non-cash prize challenge

Recommended prizes:

- Merchandise
- Vouchers
- Free court credits
- Paddle accessories
- Event access

13. Coaching and Clinic Upsell

League competition naturally creates demand for improvement.

After players lose, they become more motivated to train.

PCL can monetize:

- Team coaching clinic
- Doubles strategy masterclass
- Captain training session
- Pre-season bootcamp
- Recovery and fitness workshop
- Serve-to-win pressure training

Example:

Offer	Calculation	Revenue
PCL Team Clinic	6 clubs x RM 600	RM 3,600

This is a natural revenue stream because competition creates pain, motivation, and urgency.

14. Best Season 1 Monetization Stack

For PCL Season 1, the recommended monetization stack is:

1. Club registration fee
2. Small sponsorship packages
3. Merchandise pre-order
4. Venue partnership
5. Content sponsorship

Avoid heavy monetization from:

- Player subscriptions
- Supporter tickets
- Fantasy league
- Complicated premium features

Season 1 should prioritize adoption and proof.

15. Example Season 1 Revenue Projection

Assumption:

- 6 clubs
- 48 registered players
- 7 active competition sessions
- 4-hour weekly venue booking
- Basic content coverage

Conservative Scenario

Revenue Source	Estimate
Club Registration: 6 x RM 500	RM 3,000
Small Sponsor	RM 2,000
Merchandise Profit	RM 1,500
Venue Discount / Value	RM 1,000
Total Value	RM 7,500

Realistic Scenario

Revenue Source	Estimate
Club Registration: 6 x RM 1,000	RM 6,000
Award Sponsors	RM 4,000
Weekly Recap Sponsor	RM 3,500
Merchandise Profit	RM 3,000
Venue Partnership Value	RM 1,500
Total Value	RM 18,000

Strong Scenario

Revenue Source	Estimate
Club Registration: 6 x RM 1,500	RM 9,000
Title Sponsor	RM 10,000
Award Sponsors	RM 6,000
Weekly Content Sponsor	RM 5,600
Merchandise Profit	RM 5,000
Coaching Clinic Upsell	RM 3,600
Venue Partnership Value	RM 2,000
Total Value	RM 41,200

16. Cost Structure to Watch

PCL must carefully track costs to avoid fake profit.

Main cost items:

Cost Item	Notes
-----------	-------

Court Rental	Usually one of the biggest costs
Match Coordinator	Needed for smooth operation
Scorekeeper	Can be volunteer in Season 1
Content Creator	Important for sponsor value
Trophy and Medals	Must look premium
Social Media Design	Needed for weekly updates
App/Admin System	Can start manually first
Prizes	Keep modest in Season 1
Insurance / Liability	Important as league grows

17. Season 1 Profit Logic

Season 1 does not need to create major profit.

It should create strategic assets:

1. Sponsor case study
2. Matchday content
3. Player testimonials
4. Club testimonials
5. Retention data
6. Attendance data
7. Social media proof
8. Season 2 demand

The short-term profit may be small, but the strategic value can be large.

18. How to Sell Sponsorship

Do not sell sponsorship as simple logo placement.

That is weak.

Sell sponsorship as:

Access to an active, high-income, lifestyle sports community.

Sponsor pitch:

“PCL gives your brand direct access to active pickleball players, clubs, and supporters through weekly matches, social content, league standings, awards, and community engagement.”

Sponsor Benefits

Sponsors receive:

- Brand visibility
 - Weekly social exposure
 - Product trial opportunity
 - Venue activation
 - Player endorsement potential
 - Community trust
 - Repeated exposure
 - Lifestyle sports positioning
-

19. Sponsorship Inventory

Assets that can be monetized:

Asset	Sponsor Opportunity
League Name	Title Sponsor
Weekly Recap	Content Sponsor
MVP Award	Award Sponsor
Golden Paddle	Award Sponsor
Court Banner	Venue Activation

Player Interview	Content Sponsor
Grand Final	Event Sponsor
Club Jersey	Apparel Sponsor
Merchandise	Product Sponsor
Hydration Station	Beverage Sponsor
Top 5 Rallies	Content Sponsor
Scoreboard Graphic	Digital Sponsor

20. Recommended Sponsor Packages

Package 1: Supporting Partner

Price:

RM 1,500

Includes:

- Logo on sponsor page
 - 3 social media mentions
 - Logo on weekly recap post
 - Product booth option during final
-

Package 2: Award Partner

Price:

RM 3,000

Includes:

- Naming right for one award
- Logo on award announcement

- Mention during final
 - 5 social media posts
 - Product placement in award ceremony
-

Package 3: Matchday Partner

Price:

RM 5,000

Includes:

- One branded matchday
 - Logo on content template
 - Booth or table at venue
 - Social media tagging
 - Product sampling opportunity
 - Short brand mention in highlight video
-

Package 4: Title Partner

Price:

RM 10,000–15,000

Includes:

- “PCL Season 1 presented by [Brand]”
 - Logo on all league assets
 - Brand mention in all weekly recaps
 - Booth at opening and final
 - Award ceremony visibility
 - Social content integration
 - Product trial opportunity
 - Priority renewal for Season 2
-

21. Monetization Timeline

Pre-Season

Monetize:

- Club registration fee
 - Sponsor packages
 - Merchandise pre-order
 - Coaching clinic offer
 - Venue partnership
-

During Season

Monetize:

- Weekly content sponsorship
 - Merchandise sales
 - Venue partner activation
 - Food and beverage partner
 - Equipment demo day
 - Matchday sponsor
-

Grand Final

Monetize:

- Event sponsor
 - Ticket/supporter pass if demand exists
 - Booth rental
 - Merchandise booth
 - Brand activation
 - Award sponsorship
-

Post-Season

Monetize:

- Season 2 early registration

- Club renewal fee
 - Sponsor renewal
 - Training programs
 - Premium app subscription
 - Merchandise recap/drop
-

22. What Not to Monetize Too Early

Avoid these in Season 1:

1. Mandatory supporter ticket
2. Expensive player subscription
3. Complicated fantasy league fee
4. Heavy commission on clubs
5. High equipment sales pressure
6. Overpriced participation fee
7. Aggressive paywall for basic league access

Reason:

Season 1 needs adoption, trust, and proof first.

Monetization should support growth, not block it.

23. Recommended Season 1 Business Model

For PCL Season 1, the cleanest business model is:

1. Charge Clubs

Recommended:

RM 800–1,200 per club

2. Get Sponsors

Target:

RM 5,000–10,000 total sponsorship

3. Sell Merchandise

Model:

Pre-order only

4. Partner With Venue

Goal:

Discounted courts or sponsor-value exchange

5. Create Weekly Content

Purpose:

Use Season 1 content to sell Season 2 sponsorship at a higher price

24. Long-Term Monetization Roadmap

Season 1

Focus:

- Proof
- Participation
- Content

- Light monetization

Revenue:

- Club fees
 - Small sponsors
 - Merchandise
 - Venue partnership
-

Season 2

Add:

- Bigger sponsor packages
 - Supporter pass
 - Coaching clinics
 - Club XP system
 - Improved app stats
 - Sponsored leaderboard
-

Season 3

Add:

- Fantasy league
 - Division system
 - Premium club memberships
 - Regional sponsors
 - Larger grand final event
 - More formal media package
-

Season 4+

Add:

- National league
- Broadcast or livestream package
- International club championship

- Major brand partnerships
 - Licensing to other cities
 - White-label PCL operation model
-

25. Strategic Conclusion

PCL should be monetized as a community and media engine, not just a tournament.

The most important monetization asset is not the match itself.

The real asset is:

Weekly community attention.

If PCL can create attention every week through matches, rivalries, rankings, highlights, player stories, and club identity, then monetization becomes much easier through:

- Sponsors
- Merchandise
- Coaching
- Premium features
- Supporter engagement
- Venue partnerships
- Future regional expansion

Season 1 should prove the system.

Season 2 should optimize monetization.

Season 3 and beyond should scale the commercial model.

PLAYCIRCLE CLUB LEAGUE (PCL)

Realistic Profit & Loss Simulation

Season 1 Proof of Concept

1. Purpose

This Profit & Loss simulation estimates the realistic financial outcome for PCL Season 1.

Unlike the conservative scenario, this realistic scenario assumes that PCL is able to secure moderate participation fees, small sponsorship support, merchandise sales, and venue partnership value.

The objective is still not to maximize profit. The main objective is to validate that PCL can become a repeatable league model that increases:

- Player retention
 - Club loyalty
 - App engagement
 - Sponsor interest
 - Community participation
 - Long-term PlayCircle ecosystem value
-

2. Core Assumptions

League Format Assumption

Item		Assumption
Number of Clubs	6 clubs	
Players per Club	8 players	
Total Registered Players	48 players	
Regular Season Ties	15 ties	

Playoff Ties	4 ties
Total Ties	19 ties
Active Competition Sessions	7 sessions
Venue Booking per Session	4 hours
Total Venue Booking Hours	28 hours
Courts Used	3 courts
Active Competition Duration	7 weeks
Full Project Duration	9–10 weeks including pre-season and post-season

3. Realistic Revenue Assumptions

Revenue Source	Assumption	Amount
Club Registration Fee	6 clubs x RM 1,000	RM 6,000
Award Sponsors	2 award sponsors x RM 2,000	RM 4,000
Weekly Recap Sponsor	7 weekly recaps x RM 500	RM 3,500
Merchandise Gross Profit	Moderate pre-order batch	RM 3,000
Venue Discount / Sponsorship Value	Estimated venue support	RM 1,500
Total Revenue / Value		RM 18,000

4. Revenue Explanation

4.1 Club Registration Fee

Each participating club pays a registration fee to join PCL Season 1.

Formula:

$$6 \text{ clubs} \times \text{RM } 1,000 = \text{RM } 6,000$$

This fee helps cover:

- League administration
- Scheduling
- Scorekeeping
- Standings management
- Matchday coordination
- Basic content coverage
- Trophy and award costs

RM 1,000 per club is realistic because it creates commitment without making the league too expensive for early participants.

4.2 Award Sponsors

Award sponsorship is easier to sell than full league sponsorship because it gives sponsors a specific and visible branding asset.

Example award sponsors:

- Golden Paddle Award Sponsor
- MVP Award Sponsor
- Fan Favourite Award Sponsor
- Best Club Spirit Sponsor

Realistic assumption:

$$2 \text{ award sponsors} \times \text{RM } 2,000 = \text{RM } 4,000$$

Sponsor benefits may include:

- Award naming rights
 - Logo placement on award graphics
 - Social media mentions
 - Mention during final ceremony
 - Product placement during award presentation
-

4.3 Weekly Recap Sponsor

PCL can create weekly content recaps throughout the season.

Examples:

- Weekly results
- League table update
- MVP of the week
- Top rallies
- Player highlights
- Club rivalry content

Realistic assumption:

7 weekly recaps x RM 500 = RM 3,500

Sponsor format:

“PCL Weekly Recap powered by [Sponsor Name]”

This gives sponsors repeated exposure and gives PCL a recurring media asset.

4.4 Merchandise Gross Profit

Merchandise should be sold using a pre-order model to reduce inventory risk.

Example merchandise:

- PCL Season 1 shirt
- Club supporter shirt
- Cap
- Towel
- Bottle
- Grip tape
- Supporter kit

Example calculation:

Item	Amount
Selling Price per Shirt	RM 79

Cost per Shirt RM 35

Gross Profit per Shirt RM 44

To achieve RM 3,000 gross profit:

RM 3,000 / RM 44 = approximately 69 shirts

This is realistic if PCL has:

- 48 players
 - Supporters
 - Club members
 - Friends and family
 - Social media audience
-

4.5 Venue Discount / Sponsorship Value

Venue partnership can reduce operating cost or provide value-in-kind support.

Realistic assumption:

RM 1,500 venue value

This may come from:

- Discounted court rental
- Free extra court time
- Free final venue support
- Venue branding exchange
- Official venue partner arrangement

This is counted as value because it reduces the real burden of running the league.

5. Realistic Cost Assumptions

The realistic scenario assumes slightly better operations than the conservative scenario, especially in content, branding, and matchday quality.

Cost Item	Assumption	Amount
Court Rental	7 sessions x 4 hours x RM 180/hour	RM 5,040
League Coordinator	7 sessions x RM 200	RM 1,400
Scorekeeper / Admin Support	7 sessions x RM 100	RM 700
Content Capture	7 sessions x RM 250	RM 1,750
Trophy & Medals	Better quality awards	RM 1,200
Design & Social Templates	League table, result graphics, sponsor templates	RM 800
Printing / Signage	Score sheets, banners, sponsor boards	RM 700
Miscellaneous Buffer	Water, admin supplies, emergencies	RM 800
Total Operating Cost		RM 12,390

Rounded planning cost:

RM 12,500

6. Cost Explanation

6.1 Court Rental

Formula:

7 sessions x 4 hours x RM 180/hour = RM 5,040

Court rental remains the largest cost unless the venue provides sponsorship or discounted rates.

6.2 League Coordinator

Formula:

$$7 \text{ sessions} \times \text{RM } 200 = \text{RM } 1,400$$

The league coordinator is responsible for:

- Matchday flow
- Captain briefing
- Schedule control
- Dispute handling
- Result confirmation
- Venue coordination
- Overall matchday discipline

This role is important because poor operations can damage the perceived value of PCL.

6.3 Scorekeeper / Admin Support

Formula:

$$7 \text{ sessions} \times \text{RM } 100 = \text{RM } 700$$

This role manages:

- Score recording
 - Match results
 - Bonus point updates
 - Player statistics
 - League table updates
 - Support ranking updates
-

6.4 Content Capture

Formula:

$$7 \text{ sessions} \times \text{RM } 250 = \text{RM } 1,750$$

Content is more important in the realistic scenario because it helps create:

- Sponsor value
- Social media buzz
- Player excitement
- Club pride
- Season 2 marketing material

Content should include:

- Match highlights
 - Player photos
 - Club photos
 - MVP moments
 - Short reels
 - Weekly recap assets
-

6.5 Trophy & Medals

Estimated:

RM 1,200

This includes:

- PCL Champion trophy
- Runner-up recognition
- Third-place recognition
- Player awards
- Club awards

The awards should look premium enough to create social media value.

6.6 Design & Social Templates

Estimated:

RM 800

Includes:

- Matchday announcement template
- League table template

- Result graphics
 - Player highlight template
 - Sponsor template
 - MVP graphic
 - Final announcement design
-

6.7 Printing / Signage

Estimated:

RM 700

Includes:

- Score sheets
 - Matchday board
 - Sponsor signage
 - Venue poster
 - Basic photo backdrop
 - Club check-in forms
-

6.8 Miscellaneous Buffer

Estimated:

RM 800

Includes:

- Drinking water
 - Admin supplies
 - Emergency items
 - Replacement printing
 - Minor operational costs
-

7. Realistic P&L Summary

Including Venue Discount / Sponsorship Value

Category	Amount
Total Revenue / Value	RM 18,000
Total Operating Cost	RM 12,500
Estimated Net Profit / Surplus	RM 5,500

8. Cash vs Value Clarification

It is important to separate cash revenue from venue value.

Cash Revenue

Revenue Source	Amount
Club Registration Fee	RM 6,000
Award Sponsors	RM 4,000
Weekly Recap Sponsor	RM 3,500
Merchandise Gross Profit	RM 3,000
Total Cash Revenue	RM 16,500

Non-Cash / Cost Reduction Value

Value Source	Amount
Venue Discount / Sponsorship Value	RM 1,500

Total Revenue / Value

Category	Amount
Total Cash Revenue	RM 16,500

Venue Value	RM 1,500
Total Revenue / Value	RM 18,000

9. Alternative View: Venue Discount Applied Directly to Cost

If the RM 1,500 venue discount is applied directly to reduce cost instead of being counted as revenue value:

Adjusted Cost

Cost Category	Amount
Original Operating Cost	RM 12,500
Less Venue Discount	-RM 1,500
Adjusted Operating Cost	RM 11,000

Net Result

Category	Amount
Total Cash Revenue	RM 16,500
Adjusted Operating Cost	RM 11,000
Estimated Net Profit / Surplus	RM 5,500

The final result remains the same:

Estimated Net Profit: RM 5,500

10. Realistic Scenario Result

Under the realistic scenario, PCL Season 1 can generate an estimated surplus of:

RM 5,500

This is a healthy result for a first-season proof of concept because it means PCL can:

- Run the league professionally
 - Create content assets
 - Deliver sponsor value
 - Avoid heavy financial loss
 - Build proof for Season 2
 - Show founders that the model can be commercially viable
-

11. Break-Even Analysis

Break-Even Point

Total estimated operating cost:

RM 12,500

To break even, PCL must generate at least:

RM 12,500 total value

Or, if venue discount is applied to cost:

Adjusted operating cost:

RM 11,000

Cash revenue required to break even:

RM 11,000

Current Realistic Cash Revenue

Cash Revenue Source	Amount
---------------------	--------

Club Registration Fee	RM 6,000
Award Sponsors	RM 4,000
Weekly Recap Sponsor	RM 3,500
Merchandise Gross Profit	RM 3,000
Total Cash Revenue	RM 16,500

This means the realistic scenario is above break-even.

Margin Above Break-Even

Using adjusted operating cost:

Item	Amount
Total Cash Revenue	RM 16,500
Adjusted Operating Cost	RM 11,000
Surplus Above Break-Even	RM 5,500

12. Profit Margin

Profit Margin Based on Cash Revenue

Formula:

Net Profit / Cash Revenue x 100

Calculation:

RM 5,500 / RM 16,500 x 100 = 33.3%

Estimated profit margin:

33.3%

This is strong for a POC, but it depends heavily on securing sponsors and controlling costs.

Profit Margin Based on Total Revenue / Value

Formula:

Net Profit / Total Revenue Value x 100

Calculation:

RM 5,500 / RM 18,000 x 100 = 30.6%

Estimated margin based on total value:

30.6%

13. Sensitivity Analysis

This section shows what happens if some assumptions are weaker than expected.

Scenario A: No Weekly Recap Sponsor

Item	Amount
Original Net Profit	RM 5,500
Lost Weekly Recap Sponsor Revenue	-RM 3,500
Revised Net Profit	RM 2,000

Conclusion:

Even without weekly recap sponsor, PCL can still remain profitable if other assumptions hold.

Scenario B: Merchandise Profit Only RM 1,500

Item	Amount
Original Net Profit	RM 5,500
Merchandise Shortfall	-RM 1,500
Revised Net Profit	RM 4,000

Conclusion:

Merchandise is useful, but not the only profit driver.

Scenario C: Only 1 Award Sponsor

Item	Amount
Original Net Profit	RM 5,500
Award Sponsor Shortfall	-RM 2,000
Revised Net Profit	RM 3,500

Conclusion:

PCL remains profitable if at least one award sponsor is secured.

Scenario D: Court Rental Increases to RM 220/hour

New court rental:

7 sessions x 4 hours x RM 220 = RM 6,160

Increase vs original:

RM 6,160 - RM 5,040 = RM 1,120

Item	Amount
Original Net Profit	RM 5,500

Additional Court Cost -RM 1,120

Revised Net Profit **RM 4,380**

Conclusion:

The model can tolerate moderate venue cost increase if sponsorship revenue is secured.

Scenario E: No Venue Discount

Item	Amount
Original Net Profit	RM 5,500
Lost Venue Value	-RM 1,500
Revised Net Profit	RM 4,000

Conclusion:

Venue support is helpful, but the model is still viable without it.

14. Realistic Scenario Risk Factors

The realistic profit outcome depends on several conditions:

1. All 6 clubs pay RM 1,000
2. At least 2 award sponsors are secured
3. Weekly recap sponsor is sold
4. Merchandise achieves at least RM 3,000 gross profit
5. Court rental stays close to RM 180/hour
6. Operations remain lean
7. Content cost does not exceed budget
8. No major rescheduling or cancellation issues

If sponsorship fails, profit will reduce significantly.

15. Recommended Realistic Operating Targets

For PCL Season 1, the operating team should aim for:

Area	Target
Club Fee	RM 1,000 per club
Award Sponsors	Minimum 2 sponsors
Weekly Recap Sponsor	Minimum RM 500/week
Merchandise Gross Profit	RM 3,000
Venue Support	RM 1,500 value
Total Cost Cap	RM 12,500
Target Net Profit	RM 4,000–6,000

16. Recommended Action Plan to Achieve Realistic Scenario

Step 1: Lock Club Registration First

Target:

6 clubs x RM 1,000 = RM 6,000

This gives the league basic operating confidence.

Step 2: Sell Award Sponsorship Before Season Starts

Target:

2 award sponsors x RM 2,000 = RM 4,000

Recommended awards to sell first:

- Golden Paddle Award
- League MVP Award

These are easier to sell because they are visible and prestigious.

Step 3: Sell Weekly Recap Sponsorship

Target:

7 weeks x RM 500 = RM 3,500

Position this as:

“Weekly access to an active pickleball community.”

Step 4: Launch Merchandise Pre-Order

Target:

RM 3,000 gross profit

Estimated requirement:

Approximately 70 shirts sold at RM 44 profit per shirt.

Step 5: Negotiate Venue Partnership

Target:

RM 1,500 value

Possible negotiation:

- discounted court rate
- free extra final session hour

- free signage space
 - venue partner branding exchange
-

Step 6: Keep Operating Cost Below RM 12,500

Cost control is critical.

Do not overspend on:

- expensive trophies
 - excessive video production
 - unnecessary event decoration
 - large prize money
 - too many paid staff
-

17. Strategic Interpretation

The realistic scenario proves that PCL can become more than a retention tool.

It can become:

- a community product
- a sponsor-friendly media asset
- a seasonal revenue engine
- a content machine
- a club loyalty builder
- a premium layer inside PlayCircle

A realistic surplus of RM 5,500 is not huge, but it is meaningful because this is only Season 1.

The larger value is in creating:

- repeatable operations
 - sponsor case studies
 - player and club testimonials
 - recurring seasonal demand
 - content library for marketing
 - stronger PlayCircle brand authority
-

18. Final Realistic P&L Summary

Category	Amount
Club Registration Revenue	RM 6,000
Award Sponsorship Revenue	RM 4,000
Weekly Recap Sponsor Revenue	RM 3,500
Merchandise Gross Profit	RM 3,000
Venue Discount / Sponsorship Value	RM 1,500
Total Revenue / Value	RM 18,000
Total Operating Cost	RM 12,500
Estimated Net Profit	RM 5,500
Profit Margin Based on Cash Revenue	33.3%
Profit Margin Based on Total Value	30.6%

19. Final Conclusion

Under the realistic scenario, PCL Season 1 can generate approximately:

RM 5,500 estimated net profit

This makes the league financially healthier than the conservative scenario while still keeping the first season affordable and attractive for clubs.

The most important requirement is sponsorship execution.

Without sponsors, the league becomes close to break-even.

With sponsors, PCL becomes a profitable proof-of-concept and a strong foundation for Season 2.

The recommended realistic model is:

- 6 clubs
- RM 1,000 per club

- 2 award sponsors
- weekly recap sponsor
- merchandise pre-order
- venue support
- operating cost below RM 12,500

If executed well, Season 1 will prove both the community value and the commercial potential of PlayCircle Club League.